Spring and Rails ship with commands for rails and rake. There are additional gems, including spring-commands-rspec and spring-commands-cucumber, that extend Spring to allow those tools to be aware of the Spring background applications.

Alternatively, you can connect Spring and Bundler by attaching Spring to Bundler's binstubs. Binstubs are small scripts that are placed in your application's bin directory and automatically invoke the command in the context of a bundle exec to ensure that all the correct gems are in the path and keep you from typing bundle exec before each spring command.

To integrate Spring and RSpec, with the spring-commands-rspec gem in place, run this:

```
$ bundle exec spring binstub rspec
```

To integrate Spring with all the programs that bundler lets you run from the command line, run this one command:

```
$ bundle exec spring binstub --all
```

This command will create new binstubs for executables that Bundler knows about, and it'll augment the existing binstubs to be Spring-aware. The upshot is that after this command is created, you have at least three things:

- A bin/spring script that will start Spring.
- Springified versions of bin/rake and bin/rails that use the existing Spring setup. (Spring tweaks Rails's existing rake and rails scripts.)
- A new bin/rspec that uses the Spring setup to run RSpec.

All of these scripts are Bundler-aware—that's the point of having these bin/ versions of each script. If you have other executables known to Spring, you may have grown another bin script or two.

Once Spring is installed, you can invoke the binstubs directly as, for example, bin/rspec, and the Springified version will be invoked. (I have command-line aliases called brake, brails, and bspec. You could also tweak your PATH to look at a local bin directory first, though this is a potential security issue on projects you don't know.)

It Don't Mean a Thing If It Ain't Got That Spring

How useful all this is depends on what you're trying to do.

Essentially, Spring is useful to the extent that startup time is swamping your test runtime. This normally happens in one of the following cases: